

6.3 Phishing



Mail Intended To Phish The Recipient's eBay Account Information

—source Wikipedia

Phishing, also called spoofing, is the act of attempting to fraudulently acquire sensitive information, such as passwords and credit card details, by masquerading as a trustworthy person or business with a real need for such information in a seemingly official electronic notification or message. The e-mail directs the user to visit a Web site where they are asked to update personal information, such as passwords and credit card, social security, and bank account numbers, that the legitimate organisation already has.

Such attacks are classified as social engineering attacks because perpetrators acquire the details by gaining the victims trust. As is obvious, the term phishing comes from the fact that these Internet scammers use sophisticated lures as they “fish” for users’ financial information and password data.